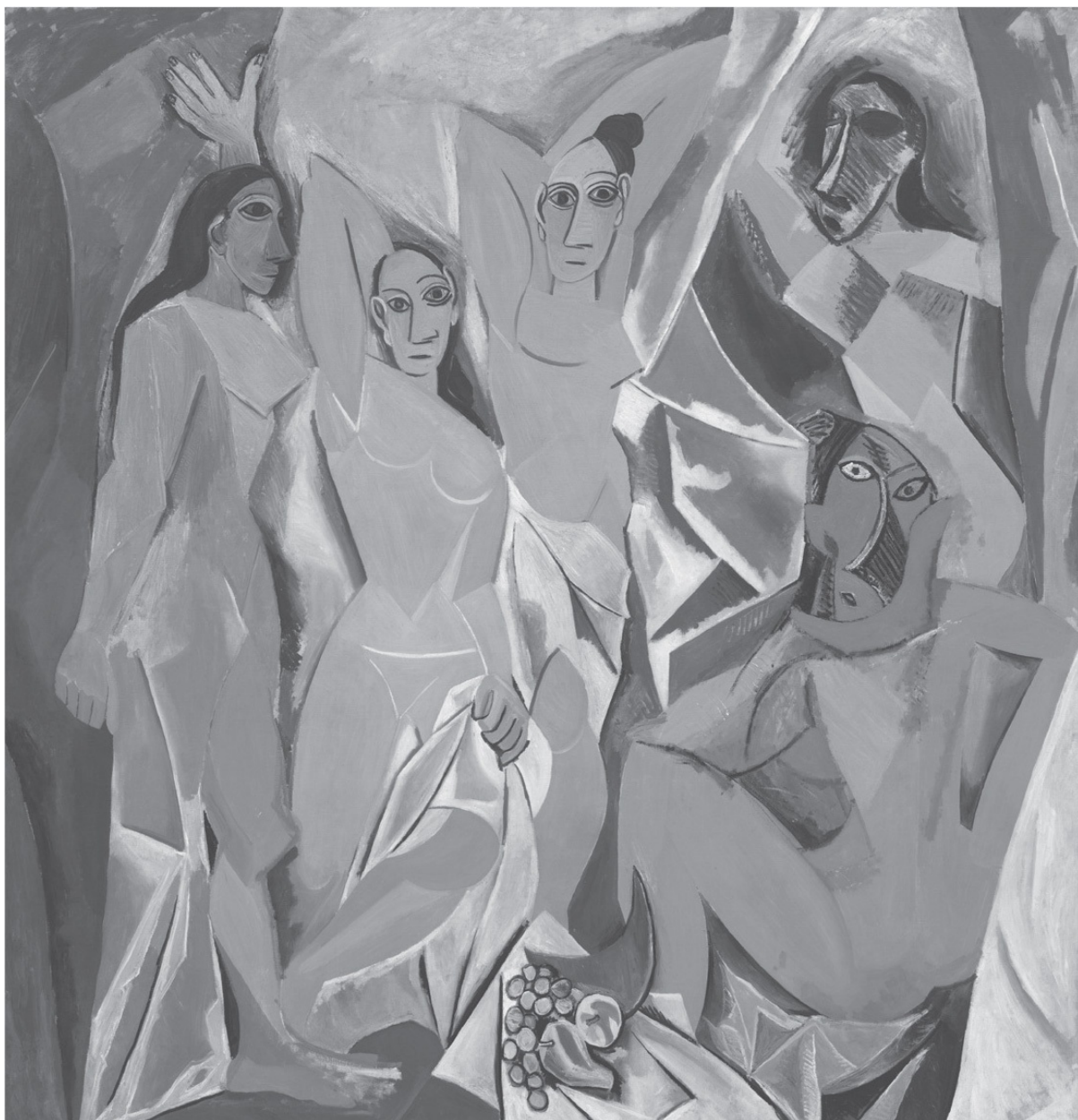


Picasso

Probably the most influential artist of the 20th century, Pablo Ruiz y Picasso (1881–1973) was a painter, draughtsman, sculptor, printmaker, ceramicist and set designer. In a career that lasted over 75 years, he produced more than 2,000 works and changed the course of art. A child prodigy in Spain, he painted at first with great realism. In 1900, at the age of 19, he moved to Paris and, over the next decade, experimented with different theories, techniques and ideas. While many of his later styles have not been named, the earliest included his Blue Period (1901–04), Rose Period (1904–06), African-influenced Period (1907–09), Analytical Cubism (1909–12) and Synthetic Cubism (1912–19). His distorted figures included Neoclassical and Metamorphic phases in the 1920s. He continued to make developments in various media, each original and powerful. He co-founded Cubism, invented constructed sculpture, introduced collage into fine art, became involved in Surrealism and created emotive works capturing the horrors of war, most notably the German Luftwaffe's bombing of Guernica in the Spanish Civil War.



Picasso, *Les Femmes d'Alger (O Version O)*, 1907